



Security Watch

Java Vulnerability

The Problem



A flaw in Sun's plug-in for running Java on several browsers and OSes

could allow a virus to spread through Windows and Linux PCs. This flaw allows a malicious Web site accessed through a victim's browser to bypass the Java plugin's protections. The Java plug-in enables small programs known as applets to run safely on a user's computer. However, the flaw allows execution of attacker-supplied code without user interaction, apart from, of course, viewing the malicious page.

Damages

Security information provider Secunia rates this flaw "highly critical." An attacker could use this flaw to do anything the victim normally could, including browsing, modifying or running files, uploading programs to the victim's system, or sending out data from the system.

Precautions

There is no workaround to the problem. Visit <http://sunsolve.sun.com/search/document.do?assetkey=1-26-57591-1> for details on how you can protect your system. This involves upgrading to the latest version of Java 2 Platform, Standard Edition (J2SE), the link to which can be found at the address above.

which is reviving after thousands of e-commerce and other dotcom ventures folded due to high costs and poor demand. "The policy will definitely give us a boost. If you don't have a robust Internet infrastructure, it can doom any country's future," says Amitabh Singha, president of the Service Providers Association.

DOMAINKEYS

Sign your Yahoo! Letter

Yahoo! Inc is deploying the DomainKeys e-mail signing technology worldwide, and has announced tentative support from rival ISP EarthLink Inc. The company said it has completed two-way DomainKeys support in its US-based Yahoo! Mail service, and is in the process of rolling out support across its international domains.

"In the US, we are signing messages with DomainKeys and are

checking messages with DomainKeys signatures," said Yahoo spokesperson Terrell Karlsten. "On the international side we are checking, and are deploying signing."

DomainKeys, created by Yahoo! and currently under consideration for standardization by the Internet Engineering Task Force (IETF), is designed to protect e-mail users from e-mail-borne threats—which spoof the address of the sender—such as worms and phishing attacks.

Senders create a cryptographic key pair and publish the public key in their domain name system record. They then sign outgoing mail with their private key, so recipients can authenticate, with a simple lookup, that the sending address is legitimate.

EarthLink said that it is testing the technology. The ISP is also a supporter of Sender ID, a related proposal from Microsoft and Pobox.com.

WELCOME, XBOX

Xbox To Come To India

Widely popular in the US and elsewhere, the Xbox is making a late entry in India. Microsoft recently carried out a survey with the IMRB (Indian Market Research Bureau) to explore the gaming market in the

HOT

Games



Half-Life 2, Doom 3 and their kin give us a chance to experience real eye-candy when gaming. The graphics are just breathtaking, and realism is fast approaching a monitor near you

Gaming Hardware

NOT

The hardware required to play the latest games is just too expensive.



If the cost of a high-end graphics card isn't enough, we also need new computers to be able to afford PCI-Express and the likes

country, after which they planned to launch the device.

According to Sanjeev Jha, country manager, Sujata Softech, the Xbox had not yet been launched in India due to the relatively low broadband penetration.

The Xbox will be available in a week from its launch, at a price range of Rs 12,500-13,000. Each game for the Xbox can cost anything between Rs 2,000 and Rs 3,000.

IT INNOVATORS

NASSCOM Spots Top Indian IT Innovators



One Silly Question

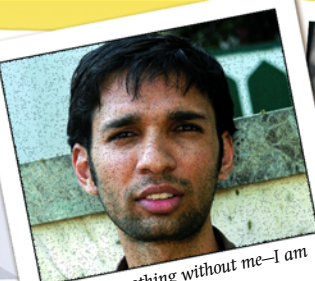
If computers could talk, what do you think they would say?



Shut Down
Ruchir Khare, Ratnagiri



Finally!!!! I can voice my data aka thoughts... What took you so long?
Mihir Hardikar, Mumbai



You can do nothing without me—I am smarter than you are
Pravin Bajad, Mumbai



There's a bug! REBOOT!
Gautam Jain, Mumbai



SENSE (they would make sense)
Ashish Razdan, Kashmir